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17 October 2019

DEPARTMENT OF DEFENSE HANDBOOK

AMMUNITION MANUFACTURERS AND THEIR SYMBOLS

AMSC N/A FSC 13GP

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FOREWORD

1. This Military Handbook is approved for use by all Departments and Agencies of the Department of Defense.

2. Comments, suggestions, or questions on this document should be addressed to U.S. Army DEVCOM Armaments Center, ATTN: FCDD-ACE-QSA, Picatinny Arsenal, NJ 07806-5000 or emailed to usarmy.pica.devcom-ac.list.ardec-stdzn-branch@army.mil. Since contact information can change, you may want to verify the currency of this address information using the ASSIST Online database at https://assist.dla.mil.

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SUMMARY OF CHANGE 1 MODIFICATIONS

1. Updated Armament Center standardization information in the Forward.
2. Updated “ammunition lot” definition slightly in 3.2 to match MIL-STD-1168.
3. Included full “ammunition lot number” definition in 3.3 to match MIL-STD-1168.
4. Updated submission information in paragraphs 4.2 and 4.3.
5. Included Table I as searchable text rather than embedded image and included after 4.3.
6. Updated office symbol and email information for Joint Munitions Command throughout document including 4.3 and 4.5.

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1. SCOPE

1.1 Scope. This handbook establishes and describes the manufacturer's identification symbol used in the lot numbers for all Department of Defense (DOD) contracted manufacture, renovation, or regrouping of ammunition and ammunition components. Manufacturer’s Identification Symbols (MIS) should not be used for commercial purposes. Manufacturer’s identification symbols are used only for government application. The usage of manufacturer's identification symbols is defined and described in MIL-STD-1168, Ammunition Lot Numbering and Ammunition Data Card.

2. APPLICABLE DOCUMENTS

2.1 General. The documents listed below are not necessarily all of the documents referenced herein, but are those needed to understand the information provided by this handbook.

2.2 Government documents.

2.2.1 Specifications, standards, and handbooks. The following specifications, standards, and handbooks form a part of this document to the extent specified herein. Unless otherwise specified, the issues of these documents are those cited in the solicitation or contract.

DEPARTMENT OF DEFENSE STANDARDS

MIL-STD-1168 – AMMUNITION LOT NUMBERING

AND AMMUNITION DATA CARDS

(Copies of these documents are available online at https://quicksearch.dla.mil.)

2.3 Order of precedence. In the event of a conflict between the text of this document and the references cited herein, the text of this document takes precedence. Nothing in this document, however, supersedes applicable laws and regulations unless a specific exemption has been obtained.

3. DEFINITIONS

3.1 Ammunition. An end item, complete round, or materiel component charged with explosives, energetics, propellants, pyrotechnics, or initiating composition for use in connection with defense or offense (including guided missiles and demolitions) as well as ammunition used for training, ceremonial, or non-operational purposes. This includes inert devices that replicate live ammunition, commonly referred to as dummy ammunition, which contain no energetic materials.

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3.2 Ammunition lot. (See MIL-STD-1168.) A quantity of homogeneous ammunition (complete rounds, components, propellants, etc.), which is manufactured, assembled, or renovated by one manufacturing activity under uniform conditions, and which is expected to function in a uniform manner. An ammunition lot is designated and identified by assignment of an ammunition lot number.

3.3 Ammunition lot number. (See MIL-STD-1168.) Ammunition lot number. An alpha-numeric designator systematically assigned to each ammunition lot at the time of manufacture or assembly that uniquely identifies the particular ammunition lot. An ammunition lot number consists of a manufacturer's identification symbol, a year of production, a month of production, an interfix number, and a sequence number. It also can contain an ammunition lot suffix, an ammunition lot identifier code, and an ammunition lot theater indicator. A lot number without an ammunition lot suffix, ammunition lot identifier, and ammunition lot theater indicator is sometimes referred to as the basic lot number or a parent lot. A lot number that has been changed in some way (such as with the addition of a suffix, lot identifier, or theater indicator) but that is still traceable to the parent lot number can be referred to as a revised lot number. When a lot number replaces an existing lot number completely, such that no part of the existing lot number was reused, then it can be said that a new lot number was assigned.

3.4 GOCO plant. Government owned, contractor operated plant.

3.5 GOGO plant. Government owned, government operated plant.

3.6 Lotting concepts. (See MIL-STD-1168.) This incorporates the basic philosophy that the homogeneous units of product comprising a lot of ammunition have been produced or assembled at the same plant under homogeneous conditions and subsequently numbered systematically to assure accurate identification and control of the lot and its major components during their entire life cycle. Moreover, it accepts the theory that all portions of the lot are reasonably identifiable or capable of being identified with the parent lot as long as the original lot number is retained in its basic form.

3.7 Manufacturer's identification symbol. (See MIL-STD-1168.) A combination of one, two or three alpha-numeric characters assigned to indicate the unique identity of the arsenal, plant, depot, station, contractor, vendor, etc., which manufactured, assembled, regrouped, or loaded a specific item of ammunition or ammunition component. The Manufacturer's Identification Symbol (MIS) is an integral part of the ammunition lot number as defined in MIL-STD-1168. It is the first entry of the lot number preceding the numeric code used to identify the year of production. The alpha characters should always be all capital letters.

4. GENERAL REQUIREMENTS

4.1 Usage. Each private contractor, GOCO and GOGO plant operation must be assigned a manufacturer's identification symbol prior to the start of production of

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component parts or assembly of complete round items. Assurance that each producer engaged in the manufacture or assembly of ammunition items is assigned a symbol prior to the start of production and the assurance of the proper use of the symbol during the production will be the responsibility of the appropriate Quality and Manufacturing personnel. The Quality and Manufacturing lead, responsible for issuing instructions and directives for reworks, renovations, modifications, etc., will also be responsible for assuring that the installation performing such operations uses the correct manufacturer's identification symbol at all times. MIL-STD-1168, Ammunition Lot Numbering and Ammunition Data Card, directs proper usage of the ammunition lot number of which the manufacturer's identification symbol is a part.

4.2 Assignment. Symbols will be assigned by the Joint Munitions Command, AMJM-QAP, Rock Island, Illinois 61299-6000. Questions regarding symbol assignments will be resolved by AMJM-QAP (usarmy.ria.jmc.mbx.warp@army.mil). Request for symbol award should be obtained via a letter with company letter head and must contain the following information:

a. Name, address and phone number of the requestor
b. Manufacturer’s name and address
c. Commercial and Government Entity (CAGE) Code
d. Contract number
e. Prime contract when request is made by a subcontractor
f. POC – Name, phone, email
g. Request must be signed by a company official

4.3 Change or update to symbol assignment. Major management changes or geographical relocation of the production facility (including within city limits) will require changes in symbol assignment or the list of revisions. Table I provides the basic guidelines in symbol assignment. It is the responsibility of the assigned party to notify AMJM-QAP of changes that may necessitate a MIS change or revision to the list. Requests for changes or updates will be forwarded to AMJM-QAP by letter. Immediate essential changes may be accomplished by telephone if followed by a confirmation letter. Information required in a request for change is:

a. Name, address and phone number of the requestor.
b. Present symbol assignment.
c. Manufacturer’s name and address (new and old if applicable).
d. Previous and new CAGE Code, if changed.
e. Reason for requesting symbol change or update (new symbol assignment, change in ownership, physical movement of plant, etc.).

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TABLE I. Guidelines for symbol assignment.

<table>
<tr><th colspan="2" rowspan="2"></th><th colspan="6">Non-Physical Changes</th></tr>
<tr><th>No Change</th><th>Change in Name</th><th>Change in Mailing Address</th><th>Contractor Change at GOCO</th><th>Change in Ownership</th><th>Other</th></tr>
<tr><td rowspan="6">Physical Production Facility Changes</td><td>No Change</td><td></td><td colspan="3" rowspan="2">No Symbol change. Submit changed information to AMJM-QAP. Table will be updated.</td><td rowspan="2"></td><td rowspan="5"></td></tr>
<tr><td>Restarting Production Plant Previously Assigned a Symbol</td><td></td></tr>
<tr><td>New Plant w/ No Previous Symbol Assigned</td><td colspan="5" rowspan="2">Request assignment of a new symbol or update of listing.</td></tr>
<tr><td>Geographic Relocation of Production Facility</td></tr>
<tr><td>Plant Ceases Production/Inactive for 10+ Years</td><td colspan="5">Symbol is inactivated and retained for record. May be reactivated or reassigned.</td></tr>
<tr><td>Other</td><td colspan="6">Contact AMJM-QAP for evaluation and assistance</td></tr>
</table>

4.4 Manufacturer listing. Each facility and its associated manufacturer's identification symbol are listed in the Worldwide Ammunition-data Repository Program (WARP). The manufacturing identification symbols are continuously updated.

4.5 Symbol listings. Each facility and its associated identification symbol are listed and searchable in the WARP database. Go to https://mhpwarp.redstone.army.mil, click on the link for MIL-HDBK-1461 and “Manufacturers Listing” under Contents. Note that this listing is only accessible to users with WARP access. Those without WARP access should contact AMJM-QAP (usarmy.ria.jmc.mbx.warp@army.mil) with list inquiries.

5. DETAILED REQUIREMENTS

This section not applicable to this handbook.

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6. NOTES

(This section contains information of a general or explanatory nature that may be helpful but is not mandatory.)

6.1 Intended use. This handbook is to be used in conjunction with MIL-STD-1168 Ammunition Lot Numbering and Ammunition Data Card.

6.2 Subject term (key word) listing.

Assignment
Identification
Listing
Status

6.3 Changes from previous issue. The margins of this handbook are marked with vertical lines to indicate where changes from the previous issue were made. This was done as a convenience only and the Government assumes no liability whatsoever for any inaccuracies in these notations.

CONCLUDING MATERIAL

Custodians:
Army-AR
Navy-OS
Air Force-170

Preparing Activity:
Army-AR

Review Activities:
Army-MI
Navy-MC

(Project 13GP-2025-001)

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